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Textual Evidence

Dear School Board Members,

Our principal, Mr. Terry, recently informed the student body that the school board will be voting whether or not to ban skateboards from school property due to safety concerns. Please do not do this. This is a position many students would agree with. I know several of my friends ride their skateboards to school because they do not own bikes. Walking would take them too much time. If you take away their ability to ride their skateboards to and from school, it will make getting to school much harder. They will have to wake up earlier for school, which will make them more tired and less able to concentrate in their classes. For example, take my friend Barry. His parents leave before the sun rises to go to work, which is way before the school opens. He relies on his skateboard to get him to and from school every day.

The school claims skateboarding is dangerous. However, it is actually a fairly safe activity according to a 2010 article in *Medical Trauma Magazine*. They found that skateboarders had 9 injuries per 1,000 skateboarders. The article also notes that there are 12 injuries per 1,000 bicyclers. Football has over double the amount of injuries as skateboarding. In comparison, skateboarding is much safer; yet, we have a football team at school and have many kids who ride bikes to school. Please do not ban skateboards in our school district.

Sincerely,

Marko DeSpeer, 7th grade

1. Which of the following statements supports the argument that skateboarding is not as dangerous as other activities?

- A. They found that skateboarders had 9 injuries per 1,000 skateboarders.
- B. Football has over double the amount of injuries as skateboarding.
- C. The school claims skateboarding is dangerous.
- D. Please do not ban skateboards in our school district.

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adapted from **The Man Who Died**
by John Buchan

1 I returned from the City about three o'clock on that May afternoon pretty well disgusted with life. I had been three months in the Old Country, and was fed up with it. If anyone had told me a year ago that I would have been feeling like that I should have laughed at him; but there was the fact. The weather made me liverish, the talk of the ordinary Englishman made me sick. I couldn't get enough exercise, and the amusements of London seemed as flat as soda-water that has been standing in the sun. *Richard Hannay,* I kept telling myself, *you have got into the wrong ditch, my friend, and you had better climb out.*

2 From the first I was disappointed with the place. In about a week I was tired of seeing sights, and in less than a month I had had enough of restaurants and theaters. I had no real pal to go about with, which probably explains things. Here was I, thirty-seven years old, sound in wind and limb, with enough money to have a good time, yawning my head off all day. I had just about settled to clear out and get back to the veld, for I was the best bored man in the United Kingdom.

3 I was just fitting my key into the door when I noticed a man at my elbow. I had not seen him approach, and the sudden appearance made me start. He was a slim man, with a short brown beard and small, blue eyes. I recognized him as the occupant of a flat[1] on the top floor, with whom I had passed the time of day on the stairs.

4 "Can I speak to you?" he said. "May I come in for a minute?" He was steadying his voice with an effort, and his hand was pawing my arm.

5 I got my door open and motioned him in. No sooner was he over the threshold than he made a dash for my back room. Then he bolted back.

6 "Is the door locked?" he asked feverishly, and he fastened the chain with his own hand.

7 "I'm very sorry," he said humbly. "It's a mighty liberty, but you looked the kind of man who would understand. I've had you in my mind all this week when things got troublesome. Say, will you do me a good turn?"

8 "I'll listen to you," I said. "That's all I'll promise." I was getting worried by the antics of this nervous little chap.

9 There was a tray of coffee on a table beside him, from which he filled himself a cup. He drank it off in three gulps, and cracked the cup as he set it down.

10 "Pardon," he said, "I'm a bit rattled tonight. You see, I happen at this moment to be dead."

11 "What does it feel like?" I asked. I was pretty certain that I had to deal with a madman.

12 A smile flickered over his drawn face. "I'm not mad—yet. I'm going to confide in you. I need help worse than any man ever needed it, and I want to know if I can count you in."

13 "Get on with your yarn," I said, "and I'll tell you."

14 He was an American, from Kentucky, and after college, being pretty well off, he had started out to see the world. He wrote a bit, and acted as war correspondent for a Chicago paper, and spent a year or two in South-Eastern Europe. I gathered that he was a fine linguist, and had got to know pretty well the society in those parts. He spoke familiarly of many names that I remembered to have seen in the newspapers.

15 He had played about with politics, he told me, at first for the interest of them, and then because he couldn't help himself. I read him as a sharp, restless fellow, who always wanted to get down to the roots of things. He got a little further down than he wanted.

1. an apartment

2. Directions: Select ALL the correct answers.
Which **two** sentences from the passage **best** support the idea that the man in the flat on the top floor was acting nervous?

- [ ] He drank it off in three gulps, and cracked the cup as he set it down.
- [ ] He was a slim man, with a short brown beard and small, blue eyes.
- [ ] "I've had you in my mind all this week when things got troublesome."
- [ ] "Is the door locked?" he asked feverishly, and he fastened the chain with his own hand.
- [ ] "I need help worse than any man ever needed it, and I want to know if I can count you in."



Ronnie was on vacation for 5 days in Vail, Colorado, with his family. His parents had let him invite a friend to come along, so he had invited his best friend Brett. Having grown up in Vermont, the boys were familiar with being around snow and skiing. But they were not familiar with the ski slopes in Vail. Ronnie's parents were worried the black slopes were too dangerous for two teenage boys. However, they wanted to ski the black slopes, so they went off on their own. Ronnie and Brett buddied up to ski together down the easier slopes. Brett wanted to start off skiing down the blue slopes, but Ronnie convinced him to take it easy since it was possible Vail's blue slopes were more difficult than the blue slopes they had gone down back home in Vermont. So they hit the green slopes instead.

They rode the chair lift up the hill. Once at the top of the hill, they began their descent down the mountain—Brett in his blue ski jacket and Ronnie in his yellow ski jacket. It was smooth sailing down the mountain. The boys decided to try a blue slope next. Once at the top of the hill, they began their trek down the mountain. Brett, feeling adventurous and confident, sped past Ronnie. Brett didn't seem to want to slow down. Ronnie kept skiing at his leisurely pace but noticed someone wearing blue suddenly falling into the powdery snow half-way down the mountain. *Could that be Brett?* Ronnie thought to himself.

Ronnie approached the blue-jacketed skier. Although the skier had snow covering his face, he could tell it was indeed Brett.

"Brett, what happened?" Ronnie asked.

"I don't know, dude. I just took a sudden tumble. Give me a moment to catch my breath. That really shook me up."

Brett began to get up but collapsed back into the snow and yelled, "Ouch, my arm!"

Ronnie leaned down to help his friend up. "Let me help you. You can hold onto me with your good arm."

Together they slowly skied down to the bottom of the hill. Ronnie found a ski medic to come look at Brett's arm. The ski medic said that Brett probably just sprained it but would need to get an X-ray to be sure.

The boys met up with Ronnie's parents who drove Brett to the closest emergency room so he could get an X-ray. Fortunately, all he had was a sprained elbow, which he was told should heal up in a few weeks. The doctor outfitted Brett with an elbow brace and told him to take it easy for the next month and to avoid any sports.

3. Which of these details supports the idea that blue slopes are harder to ski down than green slopes?

- A. Ronnie's parents are skiing down the black slopes, so the boys want to stay on the easier slopes.
- B. Ronnie suggests they go down the green slopes first since the blue ones in Vail might be harder.
- C. The boys want to ski down the blue slopes first because they skied down the blue slopes back home.
- D. The boys have had a more difficult time on Vermont's blue slopes than on the green slopes in the past.

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The school claims skateboarding is dangerous. However, it is actually a fairly safe activity according to a 2010 article in *Medical Trauma Magazine*. They found that skateboarders had 9 injuries per 1,000 skateboarders. The article also notes that there are 12 injuries per 1,000 bicyclers. Football has over double the amount of injuries as skateboarding. In comparison, skateboarding is much safer; yet, we have a football team at school and have many kids who ride bikes to school. Please do not ban skateboards in our school district.

Sincerely,

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4. Who would be most likely to agree with the letter writer?

- A. a parent whose child was injured while riding a skateboard
- B. a school board member who thinks skateboards are a nuisance
- C. a fellow student who rides his or her skateboard to school
- D. a teacher who has students who bring their skateboards to class

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Summer Activities in Somerville

When summer hits, children are ready to relax and have fun. There are a lot of programs for local children in Somerville to spice up the summer with fun.

The Somerville Children's Theater will be offering acting classes for kids ages 8–14 during the month of June. They will have classes ranging from acting in films to puppetry to musical theater. Call the theater at (812) 555-5000 for information about signing up.

The Somerville Nature Center will be hosting nature walks for families every Saturday from June 6 through August 20. On the walks, you will learn about local plants and animals. From July 25 through August 29, the center will also host a 5-day adventure day camp. Call the center at (812) 555-2020 to find out more information.

Beginning July 8 through August 1, the play *Quack-a-doodle-doo* begins at the Somerville Children's Theater. Call the ticket office at (812) 555-5000 for showtimes.

Bring out your child's inner artist at the Somerville Art Museum from August 5 through August 25. The museum is offering various art classes for children ages 10–16. Call (812) 555-8080 to sign up today.

The local YMCA will be having swimming classes for ages 3–8 during the month of June. Also if your child is between the ages of 8 and 16 and is interested in learning how to play an instrument, you can sign them up for classes until June 1. Music classes start June 8 and run through July 3. Call the YMCA at (812) 555-YMCA for more information.

5. Mr. and Mrs. Bemby's 13-year-old son Tyler wants to learn to play the guitar this summer. Based on the information in article, which of these places should they call to find out more information?

- A. the Somerville Children's Theater
- B. the Somerville Art Museum
- C. the Somerville YMCA
- D. the Somerville Nature Museum



Ronnie was on vacation for 5 days in Vail, Colorado, with his family. His parents had let him invite a friend to come along, so he had invited his best friend Brett. Having grown up in Vermont, the boys were familiar with being around snow and skiing. But they were not familiar with the ski slopes in Vail. Ronnie's parents were worried the black slopes were too dangerous for two teenage boys. However, they wanted to ski the black slopes, so they went off on their own. Ronnie and Brett buddied up to ski together down the easier slopes. Brett wanted to start off skiing down the blue slopes, but Ronnie convinced him to take it easy since it was possible Vail's blue slopes were more difficult than the blue slopes they had gone down back home in Vermont. So they hit the green slopes instead.

They rode the chair lift up the hill. Once at the top of the hill, they began their descent down the mountain—Brett in his blue ski jacket and Ronnie in his yellow ski jacket. It was smooth sailing down the mountain. The boys decided to try a blue slope next. Once at the top of the hill, they began their trek down the mountain. Brett, feeling adventurous and confident, sped past Ronnie. Brett didn't seem to want to slow down. Ronnie kept skiing at his leisurely pace but noticed someone wearing blue suddenly falling into the powdery snow half-way down the mountain. *Could that be Brett?* Ronnie thought to himself.

Ronnie approached the blue-jacketed skier. Although the skier had snow covering his face, he could tell it was indeed Brett.

"Brett, what happened?" Ronnie asked.

"I don't know, dude. I just took a sudden tumble. Give me a moment to catch my breath. That really shook me up."

Brett began to get up but collapsed back into the snow and yelled, "Ouch, my arm!"

Ronnie leaned down to help his friend up. "Let me help you. You can hold onto me with your good arm."

Together they slowly skied down to the bottom of the hill. Ronnie found a ski medic to come look at Brett's arm. The ski medic said that Brett probably just sprained it but would need to get an X-ray to be sure.

The boys met up with Ronnie's parents who drove Brett to the closest emergency room so he could get an X-ray. Fortunately, all he had was a sprained elbow, which he was told should heal up in a few weeks. The doctor outfitted Brett with an elbow brace and told him to take it easy for the next month and to avoid any sports.

6. Which detail from the story might lead Ronnie to think that the person lying in the snow might be Brett?

- A. Brett's face is covered in snow.
- B. Brett is not an experienced skier.
- C. Brett is a very clumsy person.
- D. Brett is wearing a blue ski jacket.



Last summer, I went to Michigan to stay with my grandparents. I don't get to see them often, so they were really excited to see me when I got off the plane. They took me to their house on Lake Michigan. The lake looked more like an ocean to me because it was so large. My grandparents told me that it is the fifth largest lake in the world! I also learned that Michigan got its name from the Indian words *Michi-gama* which means "large lake."

Every morning, Grandpa would wake me up, and we would take a few pieces of old bread outside and walk down to the lake's shore. There were about 20 ducks waiting for their daily breakfast. This was my favorite part of each day. After that we would ride down to the local tackle shop and get fish bait to take back home to fish. When we caught a fish, we would release it back into the lake. We would usually fish for about an hour before Grandma would call us in for breakfast.

After breakfast, we would normally play card games or dominoes. In the afternoons, I'd usually go swimming. Grandpa would typically just hang his feet off the dock to supervise me while I swam. One of the neighbor's kids named Jeremy would often join me. We would have swimming races from my grandparent's house to his house. I got so tan that summer, and my hair lightened several shades. When I flew back home at the end of the summer, my parents almost didn't recognize me because of my tanned skin and lighter hair color.

7. Which sentence from the passage shows that the narrator has changed while in Michigan?

- A. We would have swimming races from my grandparent's house to his house.
- B. I got so tan that summer, and my hair lightened several shades.
- C. After breakfast, we would usually play card games or dominoes.
- D. Last summer, I went to Michigan to stay with my grandparents.



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8. Based on this passage, which of the following is true?

- A. Ronnie's parents pay for Brett's emergency room visit.
- B. Brett cannot ski for the remaining part of the trip.
- C. The ski medic takes an X-ray of Brett's arm and elbow.
- D. Brett will get an X-ray when he returns to Vermont.

A Day for Strawberries

Rita's family had just moved to Scrantonville, Michigan. Before leaving for school, Rita's mom took a few moments to make a peanut butter and jelly sandwich for Rita. She placed the sandwich into a brown paper sack along with a bag of chips and some strawberries. Rita loved strawberries, and it wasn't too often that she got to eat them at lunch. She usually got a banana instead.

Once at the school, Rita's mom walked her daughter to the office to check Rita into the school. Rita met the counselor, Ms. Beckham, who handed her the schedule and a map of the school. Rita hugged her mom and tried to manage a smile so that her mom would not worry about her. Ms. Beckham showed Rita where her locker was located and helped her open up the locker. She also showed Rita where her classes were located on the map. As Rita began walking toward her first period class, she heard a loud bell sound. Immediately, the students who had been heading to their classes stopped and began filing outside the building through the nearest doors. Rita followed a nearby group of girls outside.

9. The reader can conclude that the alarm that Rita hears is

- A. the first period bell.
- B. the lunchtime bell.
- C. a wake-up call.
- D. a fire drill.



My mom recruited me to help her plant sweet potatoes in our garden this year. We used to grow regular white potatoes. However, my mom read a *Reader's Digest* article two months ago about how sweet potatoes cause a person's blood sugar to rise 30 percent less than white potatoes do. Ever since, she has wanted to plant sweet potatoes instead this year. Plus, sweet potatoes are packed with lots of Vitamin A and Vitamin C—another reason for my mom wanting to make the switch.

I decided to do some research about sweet potatoes and was impressed with what I found. They can help your skin look more clear and smooth. It's also good for people with high blood pressure like my grandpa. I also learned that a sweet potato bruises easily and that the bruise can spread quickly on the potato. We should not store the sweet potatoes in the refrigerator. This causes them to go bad more quickly. The more I learn about sweet potatoes, the more excited I get about growing and eating them!

10. Which sentence from the passage shows that sweet potatoes should be handled carefully?

- A. I also learned that a sweet potato bruises easily and that the bruise can spread quickly on the potato.
- B. The more I learn about sweet potatoes, the more excited I get about growing and eating them!
- C. My mom recruited me to help her plant sweet potatoes in our garden this year.
- D. I decided to do some research about sweet potatoes and was impressed with what I found.

Did you know the sun's ultraviolet (UV) rays can sunburn your eyes in a similar way to how it burns your skin? Sadly, it's true. Along with immediate damage to the eye, the sun's rays can also cause long-term vision problems such as cataracts.

According to a new study, many people wear sunglasses that proclaim they have "100% protection." However, scientists are now finding that the level of UV protection advertised may not be entirely accurate.

Sunglass fashionistas have little assurance that they are getting the actual protection they think they are buying. How can you know if the sunglasses you are buying are as protective as their label says they are? Stick to brands from trustworthy suppliers and have an eye doctor test the sunglasses. This is the best assurance that you are getting what you think you are buying.

11. Which of the following is likely true based on this passage?

- A. The best protection you can give your eyes from harmful UV rays is wearing sunglasses outside.
- B. It is impossible for a person to know the true level of protection of their sunglasses against UV rays.
- C. It is better to buy a pair of more expensive sunglasses than to buy a less expensive pair of sunglasses.
- D. Just because a pair of sunglasses says it has 100% UV protection, it may not have been total protection against UV rays.



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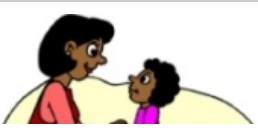
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12. Which of the following from the passage shows that Ronnie's parents are experienced skiers?

- A. Ronnie's parents were worried the black slopes were too dangerous for two teenage boys. However, they wanted to ski the black slopes, so they went off on their own.
- B. Having grown up in Vermont, the boys were familiar with being around snow and skiing.
- C. His parents had let him invite a friend to come along, so he had invited his best friend Brett.
- D. The boys met up with Ronnie's parents who drove Brett to the closest emergency room so he could get an X-ray.





My mom knew the grocery store was a place where a 4-year-old child could easily get bored and frustrated while sitting in the shopping cart. When I was about 4 years old, she would play a game in the grocery store with me called "I Spy" to keep me from getting bored while shopping and to test my knowledge on colors, shapes, or certain food items.

The game would start with my mom saying, "I spy something green and round."

I would instinctively react by looking for an item that met her description. When I spotted what I thought she was describing, I would point to the item. She would then tell me if I was correct or not.

When I would look around the store at other kids being wheeled around in shopping carts, they looked miserable and ready to go home. My mom knew how to make going to the grocery store fun, and I couldn't help but feel sorry for those other kids my age who didn't have a mom like mine.

13. Which sentence from the story shows that the narrator's experience was much different than many other's experience at the grocery store?

- A. The game would start with my mom saying, "I spy something green and round."
- B. My mom knew the grocery store was a place where a 4-year-old child could easily get bored and frustrated while sitting in the shopping cart.
- C. When I would look around the store at other kids being wheeled around in shopping carts, they looked miserable and ready to go home.
- D. When I spotted what I thought she was describing, I would point to the item.

What's Great and Not-So-Great about the Great Lakes

The Great Lakes are a group of five huge lakes found in the U.S. and Canada. Together, they cover more than 94,000 square miles. If you stood on the Moon, you could see the lakes. That's how big they are!

The largest of these lakes is Lake Superior. It is also the largest freshwater lake in the world. Lake Superior is 350 miles long and 160 miles wide. Fog and rough water cause dangerous conditions for ships. Many of the lake's nearby towns are mining areas.

Lake Huron is the second largest of the Great Lakes and is the world's third largest freshwater lake. It is 206 miles long and 183 miles wide. Violent storms often occur over this lake, and navigation can be hard in certain areas during the winter months due to ice. The water in this lake is fairly clean with little pollution. Fishing is an important industry.

Lake Ontario is the smallest of the Great Lakes. It is 193 miles long and 53 miles wide. Fishing is important here, but pollution has been a problem in this lake. Rumors of a large sea monster living in Lake Ontario have been reported over the years. It is not known if such a creature actually lives in the lake.

Lake Michigan is the only Great Lake that is not in Canada. It is surrounded by the states of Wisconsin, Illinois, Indiana, and Michigan. Lake Michigan is just a little smaller than the state of West Virginia. There are about 12 million people who live along Lake Michigan's shores and enjoy its beaches.

Lake Erie is the fourth largest of the Great Lakes. It gets its name from the Erie tribe of Native Americans who once lived along its southern shores. The lake is 241 miles long and 57 miles wide. Waste from the city of Detroit has been dumped into the lake over the years, causing the lake to emit a foul stench.

The Great Lakes are losing 2.5 billion gallons of water every day. Groups such as We Can Save The Great Lakes are trying to bring awareness to the public and are taking action to help save water loss throughout the lakes. In 2008, the U.S. states of Ohio, Michigan, New York, Pennsylvania, Illinois, Indiana, Wisconsin, and Minnesota joined forces with Ontario, a province in Canada, to save the Great Lakes. Their alliance is known as the Great Lakes Compact. The compact tells how the water supply among the five lakes should be managed.

14. Which of these supports the idea that the Great Lakes are being threatened?

- A. Many of the lake's nearby towns are mining areas.
- B. The Great Lakes is a group of five huge lakes found in the U.S. and Canada.
- C. Fog and rough water cause dangerous conditions for ships.
- D. The Great Lakes are losing 2.5 billion gallons of water every day.

Clarissa was standing in line to get her boarding pass. She was on her way to spend the summer at her grandparents' ranch in Texas. She was even wearing the cowboy hats and boots that she had bought during her last visit.

After getting her boarding pass, Clarissa made her way to the security line. The line looked rather long, and Clarissa hoped it would move quickly so that she would not miss her flight. While waiting, she read a sign that said, "Food and drinks not allowed in terminal area." She threw away her water bottle into a nearby trashcan. Once through the security checkpoint, Clarissa made her way to the terminal. She took a seat and waited for the boarding call. Upon hearing the speakers announce that her flight was ready to board, Clarissa jumped up to get in line. In just a few hours, Clarissa would be with her grandparents. The excitement of seeing them was causing butterflies to flutter in her stomach. Clarissa also could not wait to see Jasper, the newest horse her grandparents had bought. She had a feeling this summer would be the best one so far.

15. Which sentence from the passage shows that Clarissa is looking forward to going to the ranch?

- A. She had a feeling this summer would be the best one so far.
- B. Once through the security checkpoint, Clarissa made her way to the terminal.
- C. After getting her boarding pass, Clarissa made her way to the security line.
- D. She threw away her water bottle into a nearby trashcan.

Last week, I saw on the local news that there is a new city law. It says that a person can now get a parking ticket by parking on Davis Avenue Monday through Friday between the hours of 8:00 a.m. and 8:00 p.m. I told my dad about this, and he was not a happy camper. He works on Davis Avenue and often has to park on the street when the parking lot is full. He and his co-workers are planning to talk to the building's owners about alternative parking solutions.

16. Which of the following statements from the passage shows that the narrator's dad is a person who takes action?

- A. He and his co-workers are planning to talk to the building's owners about alternative parking solutions.
- B. He works on Davis Avenue and often has to park on the street when the parking lot is full.
- C. Last week, I saw on the local news that there is a new city law.
- D. I told my dad about this, and he was not a happy camper.



Some of the earliest lighthouses were simply hillside bonfires. Today, a lighthouse is commonly known as a type of tower that shines a large lamp out to the sea. The light helps to mark dangerous areas along a coast. A lighthouse also gives notice to a ship that land is near.

Many lighthouses were constructed in the 17th century. The first lighthouse in the U.S. was built in 1716 in Boston Harbor. Nearly 1,000 lighthouses were built by 1900 in the U.S. After this point, many lighthouses were abandoned and became rundown as a result.

In the U.S., the coast guard oversees the lenses and lamps of the country's lighthouses. In more recent years, the destruction of lighthouses has been rising. Groups have formed in order to restore lighthouses. Often, these lighthouses are made into parks, museums, research centers, and even inns or hotels to stay at overnight.

17. Groups that restore lighthouses would most likely agree with which of the following?

- A. Lighthouses should be owned and operated by the national government.
- B. Lighthouses are no longer useful with today's computerized technology.
- C. Lighthouses should all be restored so they are the same size and shape.
- D. Lighthouses are an important part of history that should be preserved.



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Often students do not understand why a school does not allow them to bring cell phones. One reason is because it can be a distraction in the classroom. Instead of paying attention in class, many students find reading text messages more important. As a result, students miss out on important classroom instruction.

Also, cell phones get stolen. Not only does this cause a child to lose valuable classroom time, some parents get upset with the school as a result because they are the ones who ultimately have to pay the price of the loss. Some parents will try to blame the school. To nip that problem in the bud, schools simply ban cell phones from campus.

Schools are also concerned about students using their cell phones in class to cheat. The Benenson poll showed that more than 35% of teenagers admitted to using a cell phone to cheat in some fashion while at school. Students will text each other the answers on tests. Students who have cameras on their phones might even take pictures of the test. This can get students into a lot of trouble. For every student that says he or she will not use a cell phone in a way it should not be used in school, there is another student who will break the rules. Cheating is not something schools take lightly. Many schools hand out severe punishments for cheating.

Students are not the only ones who oppose cell phone bans in schools. Some parents are bothered by this. Many parents want their children to carry phones for emergency and communication purposes. Some schools have adopted a policy where students can bring

children to carry phones for emergency and communication purposes. Some schools have adopted a policy where students can bring cell phones, but the phones must stay in lockers and cannot enter the classrooms. Whatever the case is, cell phones have changed the face of education. They have integrated themselves into our culture and are here to stay. Schools need to find fair and effective ways to regulate cell phone use among their students.

18. Which sentence from the passage supports the claim that having a cell phone in class is bad?

- A. Students are not the only ones who oppose cell phone bans in schools.
- B. As a result, students miss out on important classroom instruction.
- C. Each year, the number of students using cell phones grows.
- D. To nip that problem in the bud, schools simply ban cell phones from campus.

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19. Which of these best supports the idea that cell phones should not be completely banned?

- A. Often students do not understand why a school does not allow them to bring cell phones.
- B. Whatever the case is, cell phones have changed the face of education.
- C. Many parents want their children to carry phones for emergency and communication purposes.
- D. Students are not the only ones who oppose cell phone bans in schools.

According to research, exposure to a certain type of bacteria called *mycobacterium vaccae* which is found in soil can help increase serotonin levels in the body. Serotonin is a chemical found in the brain. It can boost a person's mood and decrease anxiety. This same chemical can help people better process information in their brains. Just by being outside, our bodies can breathe in this bacteria. Research has shown that this bacteria appeared to boost the mood in laboratory mice. Additionally, the mice that were given this bacteria in their diet were able to move through a maze twice as quickly as mice that were not given this bacteria. These same mice also behaved less anxiously than the other mice.

20. The author of this article most likely agrees that

- A. spending too much time outside playing sports could be harmful.
- B. mice should not be given *mycobacterium vaccae* in their diets.
- C. people should be given serotonin instead of *mycobacterium vaccae*.
- D. spending more time outside might help improve a person's mood.

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21. Based on information from the passage, the reader can tell that

- A. people who have less exposure to *mycobacterium vaccae* are often smarter.
- B. serotonin in a person's body can help improve that person's ability to learn.
- C. the laboratory tests on mice do not impact the effect of the bacteria on humans.
- D. many nutritional companies will start placing *mycobacterium vaccae* in food.

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22. The line below is from a story.

"It is a good thing we were all wearing lifejackets and that land was not far away when we capsized."

Based on the text, which of the following most likely happened?

- A. Swimmers were racing in a lake.
- B. There are not enough details to answer the question.
- C. A plane had a rough landing at the airport.
- D. A boat flipped over in the water.

---

23. Directions: Select the correct text in the passage.

Which set of lines shows that the speaker finds the baby to be an annoyance?

Sibling Envy

by A. Gautam

My mother brought home
a breathing doll.
She rests on the crib—

pink and soft,
like a cake in the oven.
She runs on love,
Her batteries are kisses,
She is rechargeable,
like a toy,
on midnight milk.
She doesn't do any tricks,
except she knows just how
to make Mother forget
about me.
Her magic spells
are whiny cries.
She tries,
with her watery eyes,
to win my heart.
Till my mother kisses
me too,
I am not falling
for her Barbie art.

Summer Activities in Somerville

When summer hits, children are ready to relax and have fun. There are a lot of programs for local children in Somerville to spice up the summer with fun.

The Somerville Children's Theater will be offering acting classes for kids ages 8–14 during the month of June. They will have classes ranging from acting in films to puppetry to musical theater. Call the theater at (812) 555-5000 for information about signing up.

The Somerville Nature Center will be hosting nature walks for families every Saturday from June 6 through August 20. On the walks, you will learn about local plants and animals. From July 25 through August 29, the center will also host a 5-day adventure day camp. Call the center at (812) 555-2020 to find out more information.

Beginning July 8 through August 1, the play *Quack-a-doodle-doo* begins at the Somerville Children's Theater. Call the ticket office at (812) 555-5000 for showtimes.

Bring out your child's inner artist at the Somerville Art Museum from August 5 through August 25. The museum is offering various art classes for children ages 10–16. Call (812) 555-8080 to sign up today.

The local YMCA will be having swimming classes for ages 3–8 during the month of June. Also if your child is between the ages of 8 and 16 and is interested in learning how to play an instrument, you can sign them up for classes until June 1. Music classes start June 8 and run through July 3. Call the YMCA at (812) 555-YMCA for more information.

24. According to the information in the passage, which of these numbers should a 12-year-old child wanting to learn about art call for more information?

- A. (812) 555-2020
- B. (812) 555-5000
- C. (812) 555-YMCA
- D. (812) 555-8080



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Often students do not understand why a school does not allow them to bring cell phones. One reason is because it can be a distraction in the classroom. Instead of paying attention in class, many students find reading text messages more important. As a result, students miss out on important classroom instruction.

Also, cell phones get stolen. Not only does this cause a child to lose valuable classroom time, some parents get upset with the

school as a result because they are the ones who ultimately have to pay the price of the loss. Some parents will try to blame the school. To nip that problem in the bud, schools simply ban cell phones from campus.

Schools are also concerned about students using their cell phones in class to cheat. The Benenson poll showed that more than 35% of teenagers admitted to using a cell phone to cheat in some fashion while at school. Students will text each other the answers on tests. Students who have cameras on their phones might even take pictures of the test. This can get students into a lot of trouble. For every student that says he or she will not use a cell phone in a way it should not be used in school, there is another student who will break the rules. Cheating is not something schools take lightly. Many schools hand out severe punishments for cheating.

Students are not the only ones who oppose cell phone bans in schools. Some parents are bothered by this. Many parents want their children to carry phones for emergency and communication purposes. Some schools have adopted a policy where students can bring cell phones, but the phones must stay in lockers and cannot enter the classrooms. Whatever the case is, cell phones have changed the face of education. They have integrated themselves into our culture and are here to stay. Schools need to find fair and effective ways to regulate cell phone use among their students.

25. Read this sentence from the passage.

Schools need to find fair and effective ways to regulate their use among their students.

What does this sentence from the passage imply?

- A. Schools should have severe punishments for students who use cell phones to cheat.
- B. All students have used cell phones to cheat in school at some point in their lives.
- C. It will be very difficult for schools in the U.S. to ban cell phone usage completely.
- D. Banning cellphones in schools may not be the best answer for everyone involved.

26.



Severe Weather Alert

Tuesday, March 21—Tonight, a severe storm system is moving through parts of Kansas. It will bring a threat of hail and possible tornadoes with it. The storms should shift to the east on Thursday night leaving sunny skies and no rain on Friday throughout most of Kansas.

Malerie lives in Kansas. Her dad has promised to build her a tree house. Based on the weather alert, the reader can tell that

- A. Wednesday is the best day for Malerie's dad to work on the tree house.
- B. Friday is the best day for Malerie's dad to work on the tree house.
- C. Next week is best for Malerie's dad to work on the tree house.
- D. Thursday is the best day for Malerie's dad to start building the tree house.



My mom knew the grocery store was a place where a 4-year-old child could easily get bored and frustrated while sitting in the shopping cart. When I was about 4 years old, she would play a game in the grocery store with me called "I Spy" to keep me from getting bored while shopping and to test my knowledge on colors, shapes, or certain food items.

The game would start with my mom saying, "I spy something green and round."

I would instinctively react by looking for an item that met her description. When I spotted what I thought she was describing, I would point to the item. She would then tell me if I was correct or not.

When I would look around the store at other kids being wheeled around in shopping carts, they looked miserable and ready to go home. My mom knew how to make going to the grocery store fun, and I couldn't help but feel sorry for those other kids my age who didn't have a mom like mine.

27. From the story, the reader can tell that

- A. the narrator's mom cares deeply for the narrator.
- B. the narrator's mom feels sorry for the other children.
- C. the other children wanted to play "I Spy," too.
- D. the narrator does not enjoy playing "I Spy."



Last summer, I went to Michigan to stay with my grandparents. I don't get to see them often, so they were really excited to see me when I got off the plane. They took me to their house on Lake Michigan. The lake looked more like an ocean to me because it was so large. My grandparents told me that it is the fifth largest lake in the world! I also learned that Michigan got its name from the Indian words *Michi-gama* which means "large lake."

Every morning, Grandpa would wake me up, and we would take a few pieces of old bread outside and walk down to the lake's shore. There were about 20 ducks waiting for their daily breakfast. This was my favorite part of each day. After that we would ride down to the local tackle shop and get fish bait to take back home to fish. When we caught a fish, we would release it back into the lake. We would usually fish for about an hour before Grandma would call us in for breakfast.

After breakfast, we would normally play card games or dominoes. In the afternoons, I'd usually go swimming. Grandpa would typically just hang his feet off the dock to supervise me while I swam. One of the neighbor's kids named Jeremy would often join me. We would have swimming races from my grandparent's house to his house. I got so tan that summer, and my hair lightened several shades. When I flew back home at the end of the summer, my parents almost didn't recognize me because of my tanned skin and lighter hair color.

28. According to what the narrator says about Grandpa in this passage, which word best describes him?

- A. athletic
- B. outdoorsy
- C. stingy
- D. impatient

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29. Renaldo wants to take his little sister to see a play this summer. Based on the text above, what should Renaldo do?

- A. Take his sister on a nature walk at the Somerville Nature Center.
- B. Call (812) 555-5000 for information on showtimes.
- C. Sign his sister up for a class at the Somerville Children's Theater.
- D. Call (812) 555-8080 to sign up to watch the play.

A Day for Strawberries

Rita's family had just moved to Scrantonville, Michigan. Before leaving for school, Rita's mom took a few moments to make a peanut butter and jelly sandwich for Rita. She placed the sandwich into a brown paper sack along with a bag of chips and some strawberries. Rita loved strawberries, and it wasn't too often that she got to eat them at lunch. She usually got a banana instead.

Once at the school, Rita's mom walked her daughter to the office to check Rita into the school. Rita met the counselor, Ms. Beckham, who handed her the schedule and a map of the school. Rita hugged her mom and tried to manage a smile so that her mom would not worry about her. Ms. Beckham showed Rita where her locker was located and helped her open up the locker. She also showed Rita where her classes were located on the map. As Rita began walking toward her first period class, she heard a loud bell sound. Immediately, the students who had been heading to their classes stopped and began filing outside the building through the nearest doors. Rita followed a nearby group of girls outside.

30. Which of these best supports the idea that the students at Rita's school know what to do when they hear the loud

bell?

- A. The students began going outside right after they heard the bell.
- B. The students looked around with a confused look on their faces.
- C. The students began panicking when they heard the bell sound.
- D. The students began walking much more quickly to their classes.



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31. In the story, the narrator explains the "I Spy" game. Based on what the narrator's mom said in the second paragraph, what did she "spy"?

- A. a lime
- B. an onion
- C. a lemon
- D. a grapefruit



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Often students do not understand why a school does not allow them to bring cell phones. One reason is because it can be a distraction in the classroom. Instead of paying attention in class, many students find reading text messages more important. As a result, students miss out on important classroom instruction.

Also, cell phones get stolen. Not only does this cause a child to lose valuable classroom time, some parents get upset with the school as a result because they are the ones who ultimately have to pay the price of the loss. Some parents will try to blame the school. To nip that problem in the bud, schools simply ban cell phones from campus.

Schools are also concerned about students using their cell phones in class to cheat. The Benenson poll showed that more than 35% of teenagers admitted to using a cell phone to cheat in some fashion while at school. Students will text each other the answers on tests. Students who have cameras on their phones might even take pictures of the test. This can get students into a lot of trouble. For every student that says he or she will not use a cell phone in a way it should not be used in school, there is another student who will break the rules. Cheating is not something schools take lightly. Many schools hand out severe punishments for cheating.

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32. According to the article, what piece of evidence supports the claim that cell phones are used to cheat in school?

A. One study claims that 70% of students in grades 6-12 own their own cell phones.
B. One poll reveals that teens send about 440 texts a week, with 110 of those sent from school.
C. Some schools let students carry cell phones to school, but the phones must not enter classrooms.
D. One poll shows that over 35% of teenagers said they had used a cell phone to cheat in school.



Most people enjoy going to the ballpark to eat and cheer on their favorite baseball team. However, soothing their appetite may cost them a lot of calories. At Yankee Stadium, a 7-oz. bag of peanuts has nearly 1,200 calories. One of their 200-oz. souvenir popcorn buckets pulls in 2,473 calories. Some ballparks sell pizza-sized pretzels that weigh 2 lbs. A normal-sized pretzel sold at the mall has about 300 calories. One of these gigantic ballpark ones could easily be half a day's calories. Of course, if you share it with a friend or two, you could save a considerable number of calories. At a Michigan minor league ballpark, there is a burger sold that has five patties of beef. It is served with a bowl of chili, corn chips, sour cream, and a large bun. This burger has nearly 5,000 calories, which is up to triple the number of calories some people consume in one day. The burger has nearly 300 grams of fat, which is almost 5 times the amount of fat a person should have each day. This is equal to eating about 12 McDonald's cheeseburgers. If you are watching what you eat, it might be a good idea to try to stick with eating foods lower in calories, or not snacking at all, while at a baseball game.

33. What does the author mean when he or she writes, "However, soothing their appetite may cost them a lot of calories"?

A. Eating ballpark food can be really expensive, especially if the food tastes really good.
B. Food sold in ballparks usually has less calories than foods sold in restaurants.
C. People who eat food during a baseball game are calmer than those who do not.
D. The result of eating ballpark food may be the addition of unneeded calories.

A Day for Strawberries

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Once at the school, Rita's mom walked her daughter to the office to check Rita into the school. Rita met the counselor, Ms. Beckham, who handed her the schedule and a map of the school. Rita hugged her mom and tried to manage a smile so that her mom would not worry about her. Ms. Beckham showed Rita where her locker was located and helped her open up the locker. She also showed Rita where her classes were located on the map. As Rita began walking toward her first period class, she heard a loud bell sound. Immediately, the students who had been heading to their classes stopped and began filing outside the building through the nearest doors. Rita followed a nearby group of girls outside.

34. Based on this passage, which of the following best describes Ms. Beckham?

A. a forceful person
B. someone Rita can confide in
C. someone who panics easily
D. a patient person

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35. Directions: Select the correct text in the passage.

Which sentence from the passage supports the idea that teenagers have an incomplete sense of identity?

To Dye or Not To Dye

It is not uncommon for teenagers to want to experiment with their appearance. After all, how a person looks strongly influences how other people judge him or her. As teens try to figure out who they are and how they want others to respond to them, they may try different styles of clothing. Another common way for teens to experiment with their look is with hair color. However, many school systems and parents insist that teens

simply are not old enough to make such changes. Is a little hair dye really that bad?

Many schools now state in their policy that "unnatural hair colors," such as pink or blue, are not allowed. Schools say that such hair colors can be a distraction. For instance, students may make fun of someone's blue hair during class. On the other hand, is it not just as likely that someone will be teased for dyeing his or her hair from black to blonde or for wearing clothing deemed uncool? This logic seems faulty at best, and schools should probably put more time into what their students are actually learning.

There are plenty of parents who do not want their teens dyeing their hair either. There are countless potential conflicts that may arise between parents and their teens. So, is a fight over something such as hair color really worth it? Parents should put time into making sure their children do well in school, eat right, exercise, and stay away from drugs and alcohol. Denying a teen the opportunity to experiment with hair color may lead him or her to experiment with something dangerous. It certainly seems preferable to deal with a teen having blue hair for a month than to deal with a teen who becomes addicted to cigarettes, for instance.

Leave the question of to dye or not to dye up to teens. There will be plenty of other opportunities for schools and parents to tell these kids no.

The students in Mr. Langely's art class were excited about their field trip. They were getting to see some of the paintings and sculptures they had studied in class earlier this year. They were especially looking forward to the opportunity to see one of Pablo Picasso's paintings. Plus, riding a school bus to some place away from campus caused a flurry excitement to build among the students.

When the bus pulled into the parking lot, the noise level increased. The students were ready to jump off the bus and begin their tour. Their tour guide Sheila greeted them at the bus. Once the students had filed off the bus, Sheila explained to them how the tour would work.

Once inside, the students stood around looking at the large sculptures and vivid paintings hanging on the walls. They listened while Sheila told the background of each piece. Most of the pieces were over 400 years old and very well known. Many of the students could not believe that each item had survived for so many years.

36. Which sentence from the passage shows that the class is at a museum?

- A. They were especially looking forward to the opportunity to see one of Pablo Picasso's paintings.
- B. Once the students had filed off the bus, Sheila explained to them how the tour would work.
- C. When the bus pulled into the parking lot, the noise level increased.
- D. The students in Mr. Langely's art class were excited about their field trip.

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37. Directions: Select the correct text in the passage.
Read the statement below.

We've grown used to the idea of space, and perhaps we forget that we've only just begun. We're still pioneers.

Which sentence from the passage **best** supports this statement?

excerpt from **Explosion of the Space Shuttle *Challenger***
Address to the Nation, January 28, 1986
by President Ronald W. Reagan

And I want to say something to the schoolchildren of America who were watching the live coverage of the shuttle's takeoff. I know it is hard to understand, but sometimes painful things like this happen. It's all part of the process of exploration and discovery. It's all part of taking a chance and expanding man's horizons. The future doesn't belong to the fainthearted; it belongs to the brave. The *Challenger* crew was pulling us into the future, and we'll continue to follow them.

I've always had great faith in and respect for our space program, and what happened today does nothing to diminish it. We don't hide our space program. We don't keep secrets and cover things up. We do it all up front and in public. That's the way freedom is, and we wouldn't change it for a minute.

We'll continue our quest in space. There will be more shuttle flights and more shuttle crews and, yes, more volunteers, more civilians, more teachers in space. Nothing ends here; our hopes and our journeys continue.

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38. Directions: Select the correct text in the passage.
Read the statement below.

"Pardon," he said, "I'm a bit rattled tonight. You see, I happen at this moment to be dead."

Which phrase from the passage **best** supports this statement?

excerpt from **The Man Who Died**
by John Buchan

I was just fitting my key into the door when I noticed a man at my elbow. I had not seen him approach, and the sudden appearance made me start. He was a slim man, with a short brown beard and small, blue eyes. I recognized him as the occupant of a flat on the top floor, with whom I had passed the time of day on the stairs.

"Can I speak to you?" he said. "May I come in for a minute?" He was steadying his voice with an effort, and his hand was pawing my arm.

I got my door open and motioned him in. No sooner was he over the threshold than he made a dash for my back room. Then he bolted back

"Is the door locked?" he asked feverishly, and he fastened the chain with his own hand.

"I'm very sorry," he said humbly. "It's a mighty liberty, but you looked the kind of man who would understand. I've had you in my mind all this week when things got troublesome. Say, will you do me a good turn?"

Dear School Board Members,

Our principal, Mr. Terry, recently informed the student body that the school board will be voting whether or not to ban skateboards from school property due to safety concerns. Please do not do this. This is a position many students would agree with. I know several of my friends ride their skateboards to school because they do not own bikes. Walking would take them too much time. If you take away their ability to ride their skateboards to and from school, it will make getting to school much harder. They will have to wake up earlier for school, which will make them more tired and less able to concentrate in their classes. For example, take my friend Barry. His parents leave before the sun rises to go to work, which is way before the school opens. He relies on his skateboard to get him to and from school every day.

The school claims skateboarding is dangerous. However, it is actually a fairly safe activity according to a 2010 article in *Medical Trauma Magazine*. They found that skateboarders had 9 injuries per 1,000 skateboarders. The article also notes that there are 12 injuries per 1,000 bicyclers. Football has over double the amount of injuries as skateboarding. In comparison, skateboarding is much safer; yet, we have a football team at school and have many kids who ride bikes to school. Please do not ban skateboards in our school district.

Sincerely,

Marko DeSpeer, 7th grade

39. Which statement from Marko's letter supports the idea that many students rely on using skateboards?

- A. They will have to wake up earlier for school, which will make them more tired and less able to concentrate in their classes.
- B. If you take away their ability to ride their skateboards to and from school, it will make getting to school much harder.
- C. However, it is actually a fairly safe activity according to a 2010 article in *Medical Trauma Magazine*.
- D. In comparison, skateboarding is much safer; yet, we have a football team at school and have many kids who ride bikes to school.

Internet Safety

Nearly three billion people in the world have Internet access. For many of those people, the Internet is a primary source of communication. Email, chat programs, and online phone calls allow people to connect with each other all over the world.

People also use the Internet to do research. Many websites offer information that is only available online. Students, business people, curious parents, and news reporters are just a few of the types of people who search for information online.

The Internet is not just about communication and research, though. There are a lot of ways to have fun online. You can look at pictures, listen to music, and even watch movies. If you like games, there are numerous formats that allow you to compete against your friends. Social media sites can show you what your family and friends are doing.

With so much personal information available online, it is important to be safe when using your computer. The Internet reveals a lot about other people's lives. Every day there are stories on the news about hackers stealing private emails and personal information such as addresses and credit card numbers. Keeping your information private may seem impossible, but there are a few steps you can take to stay safe online.

1. Do not sign up for sites without a parent's permission. Most social media sites have age limits. You should check to make sure you are allowed to use a site before you sign up. You should also be sure your parents know which

sites you visit. They may be able to give you some advice about how to use the site safely.
2. Create unique passwords. Commonly used passwords such as "12345" and "password" make it easy for people to access your online accounts. Decide on a password that is both easy to remember and unique to you. One easy way to do this is to make your password a short phrase or sentence, such as "LivinginChicago." To make the password even more unique, you can add numbers to it. For example, if your street address is 288 Highland Street, your password could be "Living288inChicago."
3. Read website privacy policies. Most people do not take the time scroll to the bottom of a website in order to read the privacy policy, but doing so is worth the effort. The privacy policy will tell you if the website sells your personal information to outside companies. If it does, consider logging in as a guest, rather than setting up an account.
4. Do not share personal information online with people you do not know. Even though you may feel like you know a person when you read about him or her online, be careful not to share personal information with anyone. You should never reveal where you live, your phone number, or any other private data.
5. Be aware of scams. One way to stay safe online is to know what techniques hackers are using to steal personal information. If you know what to look for, you can easily avoid becoming a victim.

The Internet has a lot to offer, but one must also be wary. By following the five steps above, you should be able to enjoy the Internet and feel safe while doing so. Taking advantage of all of the great things available online is better and safer when you keep your privacy.

40. Directions: Drag each label to the correct location on the chart. Each label can be used more than once.
Match each idea with the correct supporting statement from the passage.

Privacy concerns of the Internet

Social aspects of the Internet

Did you know the sun's ultraviolet (UV) rays can sunburn your eyes in a similar way to how it burns your skin? Sadly, it's true. Along with immediate damage to the eye, the sun's rays can also cause long-term vision problems such as cataracts.

According to a new study, many people wear sunglasses that proclaim they have "100% protection." However, scientists are now finding that the level of UV protection advertised may not be entirely accurate.

Sunglass fashionistas have little assurance that they are getting the actual protection they think they are buying. How can you know if the sunglasses you are buying are as protective as their label says they are? Stick to brands from trustworthy suppliers and have an eye doctor test the sunglasses. This is the best assurance that you are getting what you think you are buying.

41. Which sentence from the passage shows that protecting one's eyes is important?

- A. Along with immediate damage to the eye, the sun's rays can also cause long-term vision problems such as cataracts.
- B. This is the best assurance that you are getting what you think you are buying.

C. Stick to brands from trustworthy suppliers and have an eye doctor test the sunglasses.

D. According to a new study, many people wear sunglasses that proclaim they have "100% protection."



My mom recruited me to help her plant sweet potatoes in our garden this year. We used to grow regular white potatoes. However, my mom read a *Reader's Digest* article two months ago about how sweet potatoes cause a person's blood sugar to rise 30 percent less than white potatoes do. Ever since, she has wanted to plant sweet potatoes instead this year. Plus, sweet potatoes are packed with lots of Vitamin A and Vitamin C—another reason for my mom wanting to make the switch.

I decided to do some research about sweet potatoes and was impressed with what I found. They can help your skin look more clear and smooth. It's also good for people with high blood pressure like my grandpa. I also learned that a sweet potato bruises easily and that the bruise can spread quickly on the potato. We should not store the sweet potatoes in the refrigerator. This causes them to go bad more quickly. The more I learn about sweet potatoes, the more excited I get about growing and eating them!

42. Which sentence from the passage could be used to support the idea that sweet potatoes are healthy?

A. Plus, sweet potatoes are packed with lots of Vitamin A and Vitamin C. . .

B. We should not store the sweet potatoes in the refrigerator.

C. The more I learn about sweet potatoes, the more excited I get about growing and eating them!

D. I decided to do some research about sweet potatoes and was impressed with what I found.

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43. Directions: Select the correct text in the passage.

Which sentence from the passage supports the idea that depression can be difficult to recognize in teenagers?

Teenage Depression

Teenagers are certainly stereotyped as being moody. Sometimes, though, bad moods and sadness can become the norm for a teenager. With the rise in mental health awareness, one would think that most teens are getting the help they need. Unfortunately, only one in five teens suffering from depression receives professional help. Parents, teachers, friends, and teens themselves need to be better educated about depression. When left untreated, teens suffering from depression may turn to alcohol, drugs, violence, or even suicide.

At the very least, people need to be aware of the signs of depression. If a teen becomes especially sad, angry, or tired, he or she may have depression. Changes in eating and sleeping patterns, loss of interest in regular activities, difficulty concentrating, and feelings of worthlessness are also common. The key is observing how long these symptoms last—losing one's appetite for a couple of days may simply be due to a temporary disappointment. If any of these warning signs of depression have been going on for several months, though, it is crucial to seek professional help.

Adult depression is not the same as teen depression. Teens are more likely to be angry, not sad. Teens often have more physical ailments, such as headaches. They are usually more sensitive to criticism and are also less inclined to isolate themselves completely. Teens suffering from depression may socialize with fewer people or may start hanging out with different friends.

Depression should be talked about frankly in schools. Parents should also talk with their teens about depression. If teens do not know what to look for, then it may be hard for them to know something is wrong with friends or with themselves.

Summer Activities in Somerville

When summer hits, children are ready to relax and have fun. There are a lot of programs for local children in Somerville to spice up the summer with fun.

The Somerville Children's Theater will be offering acting classes for kids ages 8–14 during the month of June. They will have classes ranging from acting in films to puppetry to musical theater. Call the theater at (812) 555-5000 for information about signing up.

The Somerville Nature Center will be hosting nature walks for families every Saturday from June 6 through August 20. On the walks, you will learn about local plants and animals. From July 25 through August 29, the center will also host a 5-day adventure day camp. Call the center at (812) 555-2020 to find out more information.

Beginning July 8 through August 1, the play *Quack-a-doodle-doo* begins at the Somerville Children's Theater. Call the ticket office at (812) 555-5000 for showtimes.

Bring out your child's inner artist at the Somerville Art Museum from August 5 through August 25. The museum is offering various art classes for children ages 10–16. Call (812) 555-8080 to sign up today.

The local YMCA will be having swimming classes for ages 3–8 during the month of June. Also if your child is between the ages of 8 and 16 and is interested in learning how to play an instrument, you can sign them up for classes until June 1. Music classes start June 8 and run through July 3. Call the YMCA at (812) 555-YMCA for more information.

44. Based on the passage, the reader can tell that the Somerville Nature Center is

- A. a good place for people who enjoy the outdoors to visit.
- B. a good place for people who want to swim to visit.
- C. a place where people can take classes on drawing plant life.
- D. a place where outdoor plays are shown for the community.



Some of the earliest lighthouses were simply hillside bonfires. Today, a lighthouse is commonly known as a type of tower that shines a large lamp out to the sea. The light helps to mark dangerous areas along a coast. A lighthouse also gives notice to a ship that land is near.

Many lighthouses were constructed in the 17th century. The first lighthouse in the U.S. was built in 1716 in Boston Harbor. Nearly 1,000 lighthouses were built by 1900 in the U.S. After this point, many lighthouses were abandoned and became rundown as a result.

In the U.S., the coast guard oversees the lenses and lamps of the country's lighthouses. In more recent years, the destruction of lighthouses has been rising. Groups have formed in order to restore lighthouses. Often, these lighthouses are made into parks, museums, research centers, and even inns or hotels to stay at overnight.

45. Who would most likely be excited to see the light coming from a lighthouse?

- A. a ship's crew that was lost at sea
- B. a train conductor traveling across land
- C. a family camping in the woods
- D. a group of nomads in the desert

What's Great and Not-So-Great about the Great Lakes

The Great Lakes are a group of five huge lakes found in the U.S. and Canada. Together, they cover more than 94,000 square miles. If you stood on the Moon, you could see the lakes. That's how big they are!

The largest of these lakes is Lake Superior. It is also the largest freshwater lake in the world. Lake Superior is 350 miles long and 160 miles wide. Fog and rough water cause dangerous conditions for ships. Many of the lake's nearby towns are mining areas.

Lake Huron is the second largest of the Great Lakes and is the world's third largest freshwater lake. It is 206 miles long and 183 miles wide. Violent storms often occur over this lake, and navigation can be hard in certain areas during the winter months due to ice. The water in this lake is fairly clean with little pollution. Fishing is an important industry.

Lake Ontario is the smallest of the Great Lakes. It is 193 miles long and 53 miles wide. Fishing is important here, but pollution has been a problem in this lake. Rumors of a large sea monster living in Lake Ontario have been reported over the years. It is not known if such a creature actually lives in the lake.

Lake Michigan is the only Great Lake that is not in Canada. It is surrounded by the states of Wisconsin, Illinois, Indiana, and Michigan. Lake Michigan is just a little smaller than the state of West Virginia. There are about 12 million people who live along Lake Michigan's shores and enjoy its beaches.

Lake Erie is the fourth largest of the Great Lakes. It gets its name from the Erie tribe of Native Americans who once lived along its southern shores. The lake is 241 miles long and 57 miles wide. Waste from the city of Detroit has been dumped into the lake over the years, causing the lake to emit a foul stench.

The Great Lakes are losing 2.5 billion gallons of water every day. Groups such as We Can Save The Great Lakes are trying to bring awareness to the public and are taking action to help save water loss throughout the lakes. In 2008, the U.S. states of Ohio, Michigan, New York, Pennsylvania, Illinois, Indiana, Wisconsin, and Minnesota joined forces with Ontario, a province in Canada, to save the Great Lakes. Their alliance is known as the Great Lakes Compact. The compact tells how the water supply among the five lakes should be managed.

46. Which of these sentences from the passage illustrates the vastness of the Great Lakes?

- A. If you stood on the Moon, you could see the lakes.
- B. Their alliance is known as the Great Lakes Compact.
- C. The water in this lake is fairly clean with little pollution.
- D. Fog and rough water cause dangerous conditions for ships.

A Day for Strawberries

Rita's family had just moved to Scrantonville, Michigan. Before leaving for school, Rita's mom took a few moments to make a peanut butter and jelly sandwich for Rita. She placed the sandwich into a brown paper sack along with a bag of chips and some strawberries. Rita loved strawberries, and it wasn't too often that she got to eat them at lunch. She usually got a banana instead.

Once at the school, Rita's mom walked her daughter to the office to check Rita into the school. Rita met the counselor, Ms. Beckham, who handed her the schedule and a map of the school. Rita hugged her mom and tried to manage a smile so that her mom would not worry about her. Ms. Beckham showed Rita where her locker was located and helped her open up the locker. She also showed Rita where her classes were located on the map. As Rita began walking toward her first period class, she heard a loud bell sound. Immediately, the students who had been heading to their classes stopped and began filing outside the building through the nearest doors. Rita followed a nearby group of girls outside.

47. How does the author show that it is Rita's first day at the school?

- A. by having Rita go to her first period class instead of outside with the others when the alarm sounds
- B. by having Rita's mom pack the sack lunch and drive Rita to school.
- C. by having Rita hug her mom good-bye when it is time for Rita to go to her locker and first period class
- D. by having the counselor give Rita a school map and show Rita where her locker is

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The chemical bisphenol-A (BPA) has been linked to diseases such as cancer, diabetes, and obesity. BPA has been found in a wide range of products, from the linings in metal cans to some plastic water bottles to printer ink. New studies show that canned foods may contain dangerous levels of BPA. In one study, scientists tested 50 canned foods which included brand name fish, fruits, vegetables, beans, soups, sodas, and milk obtained in both the U.S. and Canada. Their tests showed that BPA was found in 92% of the foods they tested. They also noted that BPA levels can be different between cans of the same product and same brand.

48. Which of the following sentences from the article shows that avoiding certain types of canned food brands may not be a good plan for reducing one's exposure to BPA?

- A. Their tests showed that BPA was found in 92% of the foods they tested.
- B. They also noted that BPA levels can be different between cans of the same product and same brand.
- C. The chemical bisphenol-A (BPA) has been linked to diseases such as cancer, diabetes, and obesity.
- D. New studies show that canned foods may contain dangerous levels of BPA.

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49. Which of the following can the reader infer from this passage?

- A. Ten percent of the foods tested did not contain any levels of BPA.
- B. Drinking from certain plastic water bottles could be harmful for the body.
- C. Eating refried beans from a can is safer than touching printer ink.
- D. Canned vegetables and fruits contain less BPA than canned soups.

Clarissa was standing in line to get her boarding pass. She was on her way to spend the summer at her grandparents' ranch in Texas. She was even wearing the cowboy hats and boots that she had bought during her last visit.

After getting her boarding pass, Clarissa made her way to the security line. The line looked rather long, and Clarissa hoped it would move quickly so that she would not miss her flight. While waiting, she read a sign that said, "Food and drinks not allowed in terminal area." She threw away her water bottle into a nearby trashcan. Once through the security checkpoint, Clarissa made her way to the terminal. She took a seat and waited for the boarding call. Upon hearing the speakers announce that her flight was ready to board, Clarissa jumped up to get in line. In just a few hours, Clarissa would be with her grandparents. The excitement of seeing them was causing butterflies to flutter in her stomach. Clarissa also could not wait to see Jasper, the newest horse her grandparents had bought. She had a feeling this summer would be the best one so far.

50. Which sentence from the passage shows that this is not Clarissa's first time to Texas?

- A. She was even wearing the cowboy hats and boots that she had bought during her last visit.
- B. Clarissa also could not wait to see Jasper, the newest horse her grandparents had bought.
- C. The excitement of seeing them was causing butterflies to flutter in her stomach.
- D. She was on her way to spend the summer at her grandparents' ranch in Texas.





My mom knew the grocery store was a place where a 4-year-old child could easily get bored and frustrated while sitting in the shopping cart. When I was about 4 years old, she would play a game in the grocery store with me called "I Spy" to keep me from getting bored while shopping and to test my knowledge on colors, shapes, or certain food items.

The game would start with my mom saying, "I spy something green and round."

I would instinctively react by looking for an item that met her description. When I spotted what I thought she was describing, I would point to the item. She would then tell me if I was correct or not.

When I would look around the store at other kids being wheeled around in shopping carts, they looked miserable and ready to go home. My mom knew how to make going to the grocery store fun, and I couldn't help but feel sorry for those other kids my age who didn't have a mom like mine.

51. The narrator's mom is most similar to

- A. a doctor in a hospital.
- B. a cashier in a grocery store.
- C. a teacher in a classroom.
- D. a cook in a restaurant.



Ronnie was on vacation for 5 days in Vail, Colorado, with his family. His parents had let him invite a friend to come along, so he had invited his best friend Brett. Having grown up in Vermont, the boys were familiar with being around snow and skiing. But they were not familiar with the ski slopes in Vail. Ronnie's parents were worried the black slopes were too dangerous for two teenage boys. However, they wanted to ski the black slopes, so they went off on their own. Ronnie and Brett buddied up to ski together down the easier slopes. Brett wanted to start off skiing down the blue slopes, but Ronnie convinced him to take it easy since it was possible Vail's blue slopes were more difficult than the blue slopes they had gone down back home in Vermont. So they hit the green slopes instead.

They rode the chair lift up the hill. Once at the top of the hill, they began their descent down the mountain—Brett in his blue ski jacket and Ronnie in his yellow ski jacket. It was smooth sailing down the mountain. The boys decided to try a blue slope next. Once at the top of the hill, they began their trek down the mountain. Brett, feeling adventurous and confident, sped past Ronnie. Brett didn't seem to want to slow down. Ronnie kept skiing at his leisurely pace but noticed someone wearing blue suddenly falling into the powdery snow half-way down the mountain. *Could that be Brett?* Ronnie thought to himself.

Ronnie approached the blue-jacketed skier. Although the skier had snow covering his face, he could tell it was indeed Brett.

"Brett, what happened?" Ronnie asked.

"I don't know, dude. I just took a sudden tumble. Give me a moment to catch my breath. That really shook me up."

Brett began to get up but collapsed back into the snow and yelled, "Ouch, my arm!"

Ronnie leaned down to help his friend up. "Let me help you. You can hold onto me with your good arm."

Together they slowly skied down to the bottom of the hill. Ronnie found a ski medic to come look at Brett's arm. The ski medic said that Brett probably just sprained it but would need to get an X-ray to be sure.

The boys met up with Ronnie's parents who drove Brett to the closest emergency room so he could get an X-ray. Fortunately, all he had was a sprained elbow, which he was told should heal up in a few weeks. The doctor outfitted Brett with an elbow brace and told him to take it easy for the next month and to avoid any sports.

52. What supporting detail shows that Ronnie is a caring friend?

- A. He gets a medic to transport Brett on a snow mobile.
- B. He helps Brett get safely back down the mountain.
- C. He lets Brett borrow his old ski jacket for the trip.
- D. He convinces Brett to ski down the black slope first.

Clarissa was standing in line to get her boarding pass. She was on her way to spend the summer at her grandparents' ranch in Texas. She was even wearing the cowboy hats and boots that she had bought during her last visit.

After getting her boarding pass, Clarissa made her way to the security line. The line looked rather long, and Clarissa hoped it would move quickly so that she would not miss her flight. While waiting, she read a sign that said, "Food and drinks not allowed in terminal area." She threw away her water bottle into a nearby trashcan. Once through the security checkpoint, Clarissa made her way to the terminal. She took a seat and waited for the boarding call. Upon hearing the speakers announce that her flight was ready to board, Clarissa jumped up to get in line. In just a few hours, Clarissa would be with her grandparents. The excitement of seeing them was causing butterflies to flutter in her stomach. Clarissa also could not wait to see Jasper, the newest horse her grandparents had bought. She had a feeling this summer would be the best one so far.

53. Which sentence from the passage shows that Clarissa made it to the plane on time?

- A. Upon hearing the speakers announce that her flight was ready to board, Clarissa jumped up to get in line.
- B. While waiting, she read a sign that said, "Food and drinks not allowed in terminal area."
- C. The line looked rather long, and Clarissa hoped it would move quickly so that she would not miss her flight.
- D. After getting her boarding pass, Clarissa made her way to the security line.

Last week, I saw on the local news that there is a new city law. It says that a person can now get a parking ticket by parking on Davis Avenue Monday through Friday between the hours of 8:00 a.m. and 8:00 p.m. I told my dad about this, and he was not a happy camper. He works on Davis Avenue and often has to park on the street when the parking lot is full. He and his co-workers are planning to talk to the building's owners about alternative parking solutions.

54. Based on the passage, at which time would a driver be allowed to park a car on Davis Avenue?

- A. at 6:30 p.m. on Tuesday
- B. at 4:30 p.m. on Friday
- C. at 5:00 p.m. on Thursday
- D. at 3:00 p.m. on Sunday

According to research, exposure to a certain type of bacteria called *mycobacterium vaccae* which is found in soil can help increase serotonin levels in the body. Serotonin is a chemical found in the brain. It can boost a person's mood and decrease anxiety. This same chemical can help people better process information in their brains. Just by being outside, our bodies can breathe in this bacteria. Research has shown that this bacteria appeared to boost the mood in laboratory mice. Additionally, the mice that were given this bacteria in their diet were able to move through a maze twice as quickly as mice that were not given this bacteria. These same mice also behaved less anxiously than the other mice.

55. Which sentence from the passage shows how *mycobacterium vaccae* can benefit humans?

- A. It can boost a person's mood and decrease anxiety.
- B. These same mice behaved less anxiously than the other mice.
- C. Serotonin is a chemical found in the brain.
- D. Just by being outside, our bodies can breathe in this bacteria.

What's Great and Not-So-Great about the Great Lakes

The Great Lakes are a group of five huge lakes found in the U.S. and Canada. Together, they cover more than 94,000 square miles. If you stood on the Moon, you could see the lakes. That's how big they are!

The largest of these lakes is Lake Superior. It is also the largest freshwater lake in the world. Lake Superior is 350 miles long and 160 miles wide. Fog and rough water cause dangerous conditions for ships. Many of the lake's nearby towns are mining areas.

Lake Huron is the second largest of the Great Lakes and is the world's third largest freshwater lake. It is 206 miles long and 183 miles wide. Violent storms often occur over this lake, and navigation can be hard in certain areas during the winter months due to ice. The water in this lake is fairly clean with little pollution. Fishing is an important industry.

Lake Ontario is the smallest of the Great Lakes. It is 193 miles long and 53 miles wide. Fishing is important here, but pollution has been a problem in this lake. Rumors of a large sea monster living in Lake Ontario have been reported over the years. It is not known if such a creature actually lives in the lake.

Lake Michigan is the only Great Lake that is not in Canada. It is surrounded by the states of Wisconsin, Illinois, Indiana, and Michigan. Lake Michigan is just a little smaller than the state of West Virginia. There are about 12 million people who live along Lake Michigan's shores and enjoy its beaches.

Lake Erie is the fourth largest of the Great Lakes. It gets its name from the Erie tribe of Native Americans who once lived along its southern shores. The lake is 241 miles long and 57 miles wide. Waste from the city of Detroit has been dumped into the lake over the years, causing the lake to emit a foul stench.

The Great Lakes are losing 2.5 billion gallons of water every day. Groups such as We Can Save The Great Lakes are trying to bring awareness to the public and are taking action to help save water loss throughout the lakes. In 2008, the U.S. states of Ohio, Michigan, New York, Pennsylvania, Illinois, Indiana, Wisconsin, and Minnesota joined forces with Ontario, a province in Canada, to save the Great Lakes. Their alliance is known as the Great Lakes Compact. The compact tells how the water supply among the five lakes should be managed.

56. Based on the evidence in the passage, which statement is most likely true?

- A. Of the five Great Lakes, only Lake Superior and Lake Ontario are freshwater lakes.
- B. Scientists are concerned because they do not know why the Great Lakes are rapidly losing water.

C. Navigating through Lake Huron is difficult throughout the year due to high winds.

D. Of the five Great Lakes, Lakes Superior, Huron, Erie, and Ontario lie in both the U.S. and Canada.

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57. Alfred just let his small dog Bogie into the backyard to play. It was a little chilly outside and began to rain really hard, so Alfred called Bogie to come back inside. Alfred saw that Bogie had mud all over his paws. Alfred knows his mom will be furious if the dog gets mud all over the house because she had just cleaned the house two days ago.

What is the best way for Alfred to get Bogie inside without getting mud on the floors in the house?

A. Leave Bogie outside and hope the rain will wash off the mud before his mom arrives.

B. Turn on the sprinkler system in the yard so it can clean the mud off of Bogie's paws.

C. Get a bucket of cold water and pour it over Bogie while he stands on the porch.

D. Pick up Bogie and carry him to the bathtub to clean all of the mud off his paws.

Answers

1. B
2. --
3. B
4. C
5. C
6. D
7. B
8. B
9. D
10. A
11. D
12. A
13. C
14. D
15. A
16. A
17. D
18. B
19. C
20. D
21. B
22. D
23. --
24. D
25. D
26. B
27. A
28. B
29. B
30. A
31. A
32. D
33. D
34. D
35. --
36. A
37. --
38. --
39. B
40. --
41. A
42. A
43. --
44. A
45. A
46. A

47. D
48. B
49. B
50. A
51. C
52. B
53. A
54. D
55. A
56. D
57. D

Explanations

1. The sentence "Football has over double the amount of injuries as skateboarding" shows that skateboarding is safer than football. The article also mentions that more people are hurt riding bicycles than riding skateboards.

2. The man who lives in the flat on the top floor begins his interaction with an effort to calm his voice, and his actions afterward demonstrate a pattern of nervous behavior. " 'Is the door locked?' he asked feverishly, and he fastened the chain with his own hand" and "He drank it off in three gulps, and cracked the cup as he set it down" further expose his nervous behavior and therefore are the correct answers.

3. When Brett proposes that he and Ronnie ski down the blue slopes, Ronnie interjects by saying they should probably do the green slopes first since it is possible that the blue slopes in Vail are a lot harder than the ones in Vermont. In other words, Ronnie suggests the green slopes because they are easier to ski down.

4. Marko's letter indicates that he does not want skateboards banned. A student who relies on his skateboard to get him to and from school would be most likely to agree with Marko.

5. Look at the sixth paragraph. It tells the reader that classes for learning to play instruments will be held at the Somerville YMCA. Tyler's parents can call the YMCA to find out more information about the program.

6. In paragraph 2, the author tells us that Brett has on a blue ski jacket. The person that Ronnie sees lying in the snow later in the story is also wearing a blue ski jacket.

7. The sentence "I got so tan that summer, and my hair lightened several shades" shows that the narrator changed physically. At the beginning of the summer, he or she had lighter skin and darker hair.

8. In the passage, the doctor ordered Brett to "take it easy for the next month and to avoid any sports." Because skiing is a sport, Brett will need to avoid it for the rest of the 5-day trip.

9. Because the students begin going outside instead of to their classes when they hear the bell, the reader can conclude that the school is having a fire drill. A wake-up call is something that would happen at home. A lunchtime bell would likely come in the afternoon—not in the morning. The first period bell would likely have students scrambling to their classes and not outside.

10. The second paragraph talks about how a sweet potato bruises easily. Not handling one carefully could cause it to bruise.

11. The passage says, "However, scientists are now finding that the level of UV protection advertised may not be entirely accurate." This shows that just because a pair of sunglasses says it has 100% UV protection, it may not actually be completely protecting your eyes against UV rays.

12. Obviously, the two boys know how to ski since the author mentions they ski back home in Vermont. Because Ronnie's parents are going on the black slopes but worry that the black slopes would be too dangerous for the boys, the reader can tell that Ronnie's parents are experienced enough to take on a more difficult ski slope.

13. From reading the passage, the reader can tell that the narrator had a pleasant experience going to the grocery store as a child. The sentence "When would I look around the store at other kids being wheeled around in shopping carts, they looked miserable and ready to go home" shows that other kids the narrator encountered in the store were not happy.

14. The sentence "The Great Lakes are losing 2.5 billion gallons of water every day" shows that the Great Lakes are being threatened. The loss of water affects the economies and wildlife surrounding the lakes. The situation is so bad that the U.S. and Canada have partnered up to try to help preserve the water in the Great Lakes.

15. The passage tells readers that Clarissa thinks this will be her best summer ever. She has a very positive attitude about the summer. A person who was not looking forward to going to a Texas ranch for the summer most likely would not feel that way and would have a negative attitude.

likely would not feel that way and would have a negative attitude.

16. The narrator's dad is planning to speak with the building owners about other parking solutions. This shows he is a man who takes action to solve problems. If he was someone who does not take action on matters, then he would be doing nothing about the parking situation.

17. The passage says that groups have formed in order to restore lighthouses. The word "restore" means "to put back into the original condition." Groups that restore lighthouses would be most interested in preserving lighthouses in their original (historical) condition because they are an important part of history.

18. Look at the second paragraph which is about cell phones being a distraction during class. The sentence "As a result, students miss out on important classroom instruction" shows how cell phones can hinder what a student learns in class.

19. This sentence from the passage gives an example of why banning cell phones completely from school campuses may not be the answer.

20. The author states, "Just by being outside, our bodies can breathe in this bacteria." So, it would make sense that spending more time outside could help improve a person's mood.

21. The passage states serotonin "can help people better process information in their brains." Because learning involves the processing of information, the reader can tell that serotonin can help to improve a person's ability to learn.

22. One clue that shows the reader that a boat flipped over is the word "capsized," which means "to cause to overturn." Also, the references to "life jackets" and to the land being close show that water is involved.

23. The lines "her magic spells / are whiny cries" shows the baby's cries are an annoyance to the speaker. The word "whiny" helps to reveal that feeling.

24. Look at the fifth paragraph telling about art classes at the Somerville Art Museum. A child wanting to develop his or her artistic abilities would want to call the art museum at (812) 555-8080.

25. The author first gives reasons schools have banned cell phones. It then tells why some parents are upset by the ban. The sentence "Schools need to find fair and effective ways to regulate their use among their students" implies that banning cell phones is not fair for parents and students and is not the best solution for the problems cell phones cause in schools.

26. Look carefully back at the weather alert. Working outside during severe weather is not safe. It would be best for Malorie's dad to work on the tree house when the severe weather threat is gone and when it is not raining. The alert says that a severe storm system is forecasted for Tuesday through Thursday night and that drier weather is expected for Friday. It does not tell the reader what the weather is expected to be like for the following week.

27. The reader can tell that the narrator's mom cares deeply for the narrator because she made the extra effort to make the narrator's experience as a child at the grocery store an enjoyable and fun experience. Based on the passage, other moms likely did not make the same extra effort.

28. The narrator spends a lot of time outside with Grandpa—feeding ducks, fishing, and swimming. This shows that Grandpa is an outdoorsy person.

29. Look at the fourth paragraph. It tells that the play *Quack-a-doodle-doo* will be playing this summer at the Somerville Children's Theater and to call (812) 555-5000 for showtimes.

30. The passage says, "Immediately, the students who had been heading to their classes stopped and began filing outside the building through the nearest doors." This shows that the students knew just what to do when they heard the loud bell—go outside without hesitating.

31. The mom says, "I spy something green and round." A lime is both green and round. This best fits the description given in the narrator's example of "I Spy."

32. The sentence "The Benenson poll showed that more than 35% of teenagers admitted to using a cell phone to cheat in some fashion while at school" shows evidence that some teens use their cell phones for cheating in school.

33. The second sentence of the passage warns that food sold at a ballpark is really high in calories.

34. Ms. Beckham takes time to show Rita where her locker is and how to open it. She also uses the map to show Rita where her classes are located. This shows that she is a patient person. A less patient person might not have taken the time to do all of this.

35.

In the passage, the author states that teens experiment with different styles of clothing and hair color because they

are trying to develop their own sense of identity. The sentence that supports this idea is "As teens try to figure out who they are and how they want others to respond to them, they may try different styles of clothing."

36. A museum is a place where works of art or other objects of value are kept and displayed. The sentence "They were especially looking forward to the opportunity to see one of Pablo Picasso's paintings" shows that they are going to place to where art from famous artists are displayed. The students are familiar with Picasso's work and understand the rare opportunity of getting to see one of his pieces in person. They know that his work is of value.

37. President Reagan explains that with exploration comes loss, but the United States—particularly NASA and the space program—will not stop being pioneers even though the country has suffered a great loss. Therefore, "We'll continue our quest in space" is the correct answer.

38. The man from the top floor believes himself to be dead. The phrase "and the sudden appearance made me start" expresses how the narrator is startled upon noticing a person who was not there before suddenly appearing as a ghost or spirit might.

39. The sentence "If you take away their ability to ride their skateboards to and from school, it will make getting to school much harder" shows that some of the students need to a skateboard to get to and from school more quickly and easily. Marko then further supports this claim using his friend Barry's situation as an example.

40.

"Email, chat programs, and online phone calls allow people to connect with each other all over the world" and "There are a lot of ways to have fun online. You can look at pictures, listen to music, and even watch movies" are examples of evidence that support social aspects of the Internet.

"Create unique passwords. Commonly used passwords such as '12345' and 'password' make it easy for people to access your online accounts" and "Even though you may feel like you know a person when you read about him or her online, be careful not to share personal information with anyone" are examples of evidence that support privacy concerns related to the Internet.

41. The sun's UV rays are harmful to a person's eyes. The sentence "Along with immediate damage to the eye, the sun's rays can also cause long-term vision problems such as cataracts" shows that protecting one's eyes from the sun is important. It tells about the kind of sun damage that can happen to one's eyes.

42. Vitamins A and C are good for the body. Sweet potatoes have a lot of these vitamins, making them a healthy food.

43.

The author of this passage is in favor of raising awareness about depression in teens. Because teenagers are already prone to have changes in mood or behavior and behave differently from adults suffering from depression, it is not always easy to recognize. The sentence that supports this idea is "Adult depression is not the same as teen depression."

44. In the third paragraph, the passage says the nature center will be having nature walks for families to learn about local plants and animals. From this, the reader can tell that the Somerville Nature Center is a good place to visit if you like being outside.

45. Because a lighthouse shines a light from off a coastline, a ship's crew that was lost at sea would be most excited to see a lighthouse. This would indicate that they are near land and closer to finding their way home.

46. The sentence "If you stood on the Moon, you could see the lakes" shows how big the Great Lakes actually are. That is pretty impressive since the Moon is about 250,000 miles from Earth.

47. A new student to a school would likely be given a school map so he or she can find classrooms more easily. He or she might also be shown where his or her locker is located.

48. The sentence "They also noted that BPA levels can be different between cans of the same product and same brand" shows that one can of the same food and same brand have a different BPA level than another can of the same food and same brand.

49. The passage states, "BPA has been found in a wide range of products, from the linings in metal cans to some plastic water bottles to printer ink." Because some plastic bottles may contain BPA, it is safe to conclude that drinking from certain plastic water bottles could be harmful for the body.

50. The phrase "during her last visit" refers to her last visit to her grandparents' ranch. This shows that this is not her first time to go to her grandparents' ranch. The previous sentence tells the reader where the ranch is located—Texas.

51. The narrator's mom is most similar to a teacher in a classroom because she is using the grocery store as a

teachable moment to teach the narrator about shapes, colors, and items found in the grocery store.

52. In the story, Ronnie helps Brett get down safely down the mountain. A non-caring friend would have just left Brett to figure out a way to get down on his own.

53. The sentence "Upon hearing the speakers announce that her flight was ready to board, Clarissa jumped up to get in line" shows that Clarissa makes it to her flight on time. If she was late, the plane would have already left and she would not have heard the boarding call or been able to jump in line to board the plane.

54. The new traffic law says that no parking is allowed on Davis Avenue Mondays, Tuesdays, Wednesdays, Thursday, or Fridays between the hours of 8:00 a.m. and 8:00 p.m. However, a person can park there on Saturdays or Sundays, so a person would be allowed to park a car there at 3:00 p.m. on Sunday.

55. The sentence "It can boost a person's mood and decrease anxiety" shows what effect *mycobacterium vaccae* can have on humans. This is a result of the bacteria's ability to increase serotonin levels, which helps to put a person in a better mood and to feel less anxious.

56. Look at the first paragraph. It states, "The Great Lakes are a group of five huge lakes found in the U.S. and Canada." Then look at the fifth paragraph. It states, "Lake Michigan is the only Great Lake that is not in Canada." From these two sentences, the reader can tell that all of the Great Lakes except for Lake Michigan lie in both the U.S. and Canada.

57. Alfred knows he must get the dog inside but not get any mud on the floors. So the most efficient solution would be to pick up Bogie and carry him to the bathtub in order to clean the mud off his paws. The other choices may or may not get Bogie's paws cleaned.